

041. Chapter 3 Verses 40-42

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 3.40

इन्द्रियाणि मनो बुद्धिरस्याधिष्ठानमुच्यते ।
एतैर्विमोहयत्येष ज्ञानमावृत्य देहिनम् ॥ 40 ॥

indriyāṇi mano buddhir
asyādhiṣṭhānamucyate |
etairvimohayatyeṣa
jñānamāvṛtya dehinam ||

◆ indriyāṇi – the senses; manaḥ – the mind; buddhiḥ – the intellect; ◆ asya – its; adhiṣṭhānam – seat/abode; ucyate – is called; ◆ etaiḥ – by these; vimohayati – deludes; eṣaḥ – this (desire); ◆ jñānam – knowledge; āvṛtya – covering; dehinam – the embodied soul.

The senses, the mind, and the intellect are the seat of kama. Functioning through them this kama deluded the embodied by veiling the wisdom.

VERSE 3.41

तस्मात्त्वमिन्द्रियाण्यादौ नियम्य भरतर्षभ ।
पाप्मानं प्रजहि ह्येनं ज्ञानविज्ञाननाशनम् ॥ 41 ॥

tasmāttvamindriyāṇyādau
niyamyā bharatarṣabha |
pāpmānaṁ prajahi hyenaṁ
jñānavijñānanāśanam ||

◆ tasmāt – therefore; tvam – you; indriyāṇi – the senses; ādau – in the beginning; ◆ niyamyā – controlling; bharata-ṛṣabha – O best of the Bharatas; ◆ pāpmānaṁ – the sinful; prajahi – slay; hi – indeed; enaṁ – this (desire); ◆ jñāna-vijñāna – of knowledge and realization; nāśanam – destroyer.

O Arjuna! Therefore, having controlled the senses in the beginning, kill surely this kama, the sinful destroyer of knowledge and Self-realisation.

VERSE 3.42

इन्द्रियाणि पराण्याहुरिन्द्रियेभ्यः परं मनः ।
मनसस्तु परा बुद्धिर्यो बुद्धेः परतस्तु सः ॥ 42 ॥

indriyāṇi parāṇyāhur
indriyebhyas param manah |
manasastu parā buddhir
yobuddheḥ paratastu saḥ ||

◆ indriyāṇi – the senses; parāṇi – superior; āhuḥ – they say; ◆ indriyebhyaḥ – than the senses; param – superior; manah – the mind; ◆ manasaḥ – than the mind; tu – but; parā – superior; buddhiḥ – the intellect; ◆ yaḥ – who; buddheḥ – than the intellect; parataḥ – superior; tu – but; saḥ – He (the Soul).

They say that the senses are superior (to the body), superior to the senses is the mind, superior to the mind is the intellect, but superior than the intellect is He (the Atman).